

Checklist:

Key Outcomes

1. DEFINE the key customer outcome

- ☐ We can clearly describe the **outcome customers want**, not just the feature they use.
- ☐ The outcome explains **why customers use the product**, not merely how they use it.
- ☐ The outcome is something customers genuinely care about and are willing to spend money, time, or effort on.
- ☐ We have validated the outcome through customer interviews, surveys, usage data, or sales conversations.
- ☐ We can describe the outcome in the customer's language.
- ☐ The outcome is durable enough to guide product decisions for the next 2-3 years.
- ☐ The outcome is specific enough to help us prioritize what to build.

2. TEST whether the outcome matters

- ☐ Customers would recognize this as a meaningful improvement in their lives or work.
- ☐ Customers would be willing to switch, pay, renew, or expand as a result of this outcome.
- ☐ We understand what customers currently do instead.
- ☐ We know what "better" looks like from the customer's perspective.
- ☐ We have identified the emotional, financial, or practical value customers receive.
- ☐ We are not confusing internal engagement metrics with real customer value.

3. Choose a **STRONG** customer outcome metric

- ☐ The metric measures customer value, not just company activity.
- ☐ The metric is tied to the customer's desired result.
- ☐ It can be measured directly or through a reliable proxy.

- ☐ It avoids vanity metrics such as clicks, views, or raw usage unless those clearly connect to value.
- ☐ It helps us know whether the product is making customers more successful.
- ☐ It would still matter even if our current product changed significantly.

4. Aim for a 10x OUTCOME

- ☐ The chosen outcome is ambitious enough to create meaningful differentiation.
- ☐ We are not settling for a small usability improvement when customers need a much bigger result.
- ☐ We have identified what would make the product dramatically better for customers.
- ☐ We can explain why achieving this outcome would also create business value.
- ☐ The team understands what “10x better” would mean in practical terms for customers.

5. Define the key BUSINESS outcome

- ☐ Leadership agrees on the primary business outcome we are optimizing for.
- ☐ We know whether success means revenue growth, retention, margin improvement, expansion, valuation growth, or another outcome.
- ☐ We have clarified whether growth should come from new customers, existing customers, upsell, retention, pricing, or efficiency.
- ☐ We have resolved competing definitions of success across sales, marketing, product, customer success, and engineering.
- ☐ Product priorities are evaluated against both customer outcome and business outcome.

6. BALANCE customer value and company value

- ☐ We understand how customer value creates the opportunity for business value.
- ☐ We are not extracting more value from customers than we are delivering.
- ☐ Pricing, monetization, and packaging decisions are tied to customer ROI.
- ☐ We are watching for signs of over-monetization, such as churn, complaints, declining trust, or competitor switching.
- ☐ We are investing in customer value before trying to capture more revenue.
- ☐ We know which product improvements would increase both customer value and business results.

7. Build a CUSTOMER outcome PYRAMID

- ☐ We have placed the key customer outcome at the top of the pyramid.
- ☐ We have broken that outcome into major drivers.
- ☐ We have identified leading indicators that influence the outcome.
- ☐ We have identified lagging indicators that confirm the outcome was achieved.
- ☐ Each metric in the pyramid has a clear relationship to the metric above it.
- ☐ The pyramid is simple enough for the team to understand and use.
- ☐ The pyramid helps product teams decide what to improve next.

8. Build a BUSINESS outcome PYRAMID

- ☐ We have placed the key business outcome at the top of the pyramid.
- ☐ We have broken it into the business drivers that create that outcome.
- ☐ We have connected business drivers to customer value where possible.
- ☐ We can see where customer outcomes and business outcomes reinforce each other.
- ☐ We have identified which business metrics product can influence directly.
- ☐ We have identified which business metrics belong primarily to sales, marketing, or customer success.

9. ALIGN teams around time horizons

- ☐ Customer success and account management are focused on renewals, retention, and account growth.
- ☐ Sales is focused on near-term pipeline and closing deals.
- ☐ Marketing is focused on shaping demand and building future pipeline.
- ☐ Product is focused on creating future customer value.
- ☐ The organization understands that product work may affect business outcomes over multiple quarters or years.
- ☐ Product is not judged only by short-term revenue movement.

10. VALIDATE with customers and the market

- ☐ We have asked customers what result they are trying to achieve.
- ☐ We have asked prospects what metric would make them expand, renew, or switch.
- ☐ We have looked for differences across customer segments or stakeholders.
- ☐ We have identified whether different users, buyers, or customers need different outcome pyramids.
- ☐ We have confirmed that the chosen outcome is not just an internal assumption.

- ☐ We have reviewed competitors to understand whether they deliver the outcome better than we do.

11. Use outcomes to GUIDE product decisions

- ☐ Roadmap items are tied to customer outcome drivers.
- ☐ We can explain how each major product investment improves the outcome pyramid.
- ☐ We avoid optimizing metrics that harm customer trust or value.
- ☐ We prioritize work that increases the ceiling of customer value, not only work that captures more of existing value.
- ☐ We use metrics to learn, not just to prove success.
- ☐ We revisit priorities when metrics show we are optimizing the wrong thing.

12. Final READINESS check

- ☐ We know the key customer outcome.
- ☐ We know the key business outcome.
- ☐ We know how customer value leads to business value.
- ☐ We have outcome pyramids for both customer and business outcomes.
- ☐ We have leading and lagging indicators.
- ☐ We have validated the outcomes with customers.
- ☐ We have aligned the product, sales, marketing, customer success, and leadership teams.
- ☐ We can use this framework to make decisions about roadmap, pricing, and prioritization.